

A Google Docs competitor?

Microsoft is said to be updating their Office web apps soon with real-time editing almost identical to Google Docs.



A basic necessity

A recent survey by TP-Link reports that 50% of the people in UK spend more time on the internet than food or shelter.

Acquiring Traits via Intelligent Design

In a fiercely competitive space, the only differentiator is going to be the software. This month's mobile watch looks at some of the updates on that front

Competing platforms are gradually becoming almost indistinguishable from each other, with the accompanying ecosystems currently possibly the biggest differentiators. iOS 7 was recently revealed at WWDC 2013, and while it does look to be interesting, Apple has undeniably integrated aspects of competing OSes, from Android to Windows Phone. Join us as we revisit some of the biggest happenings in the mobile space since we last met.

Apple iOS 7

The new OS brings in a completely different user interface. Tim Cook described this as the biggest iOS update since the launch of the iPhone. The iOS 7 beta software and SDK are available immediately for iOS Developer Program members. For the consumers, the new OS will be available "this fall".

At the moment, Apple says the update will be available for the iPhone 4 and later, iPad 2 and later, iPad mini and iPod touch 5th Generation, with most of the older generation devices missing out on some new features.

"There is a profound and enduring beauty in simplicity, in clarity, in efficiency. True simplicity is derived from so much more than just the absence of clutter and ornamentation—it's about bringing



The all new iOS 7. Is it borrowed design?

order to complexity," said Jony Ive, Apple's senior vice president of Design. "iOS 7 is a clear representation of these goals. It has a whole new structure that is coherent and applied across the entire system."

The new OS will bring in a lot of new features, as well as tweak some existing ones to make them better.

Control Centre: Essentially a bunch of settings that you can quickly access anywhere in the UI by swiping up from the bottom of the screen. Quick settings like Airplane Mode, Brightness levels, Wi-Fi, AirPlay, music playback etc. will be available.

Notifications: The new Today feature gives you an at-a-glance view of your day with a summary of the important details. Notification Center is now available from the Lock screen as well, and a Notification Sync feature will be used across all devices.

Multi-tasking: Extended to all apps that you may have on

the device, and the visual layout of how you manage switching between apps has also been given a complete overhaul - double tapping home to get to the option remains the same.

AirDrop: This makes sharing files between Apple devices a lot easier. It works exactly as it does between two Macs. Apple did take a dig at the NFC technology, by joking about the fact that AirDrop negates the need to go around tapping phones with each other!

Camera app: New features like filters, real-time photo effects were added. The square camera has been added, and users can quickly switch between the four cameras—video, photo, square and panorama—with just a swipe within the app.

Photos app: The biggest new feature is called Moments, which automatically organises your photos and videos based on time and location they were shot. The new iCloud Photo Sharing allows your family and

friends to add photos to your photo streams, and more.

Safari app: Full-screen browsing mode has been added. Smart Search field now looks through your bookmarks and online search results simultaneously. Tab-stacking has been reworked as well. The iCloud Keychain will also be able to store your passwords and credit card information and make them available across all devices.

SIRI: The female voice has been changed, and a male voice has also been added. There is now the language option as well, with German and French being two examples.

Music app: Addition of the new iTunes Radio, a free Internet radio service featuring over 200 stations and music from the iTunes Store.

Find My iPhone Activation Lock: Requires your Apple ID and password before you can turn off Find My iPhone, erase data or re-activate a device after it's been remotely erased.

FaceTime audio calls: This will allow users to make voice only calls over the service, on Wi-Fi or a mobile service provider's data connection.

BlackBerry OS 10.2 Details

Not long after the BlackBerry OS 10.1 update was rolled out, the company is completely focused on getting the OS 10.2